VisualTax™

T3 and Forms
Quick start guide

This manual contains brief operating instructions for the T3 and Forms software.
Each VisualTax software product contains on-line context sensitive help.
The on-line help system contains the most up-today material and it should be used on a regular basis.

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Installation

The TF program is distributed on a CD.

Under the Start | Run window enter X:\Setup where X is your CD drive letter. On the displayed window click on the Common Components and then click the Install button. Repeat for the TF item on the list. The program will be installed by default on the C:\TF-2003 directory. You can change this default by clicking on the Browse button when prompted. *If you do, ensure that the destination path you specify does not have any subdirectory name that is more than eight characters.*

You should reboot your computer after installation. ***Note:*** The Common Components need to be installed only once. They are used by all VisualTax 32-bit based programs.

Alternatively you may install the program by using your Windows Explorer to display the contents of the CD. Then:

a. Click on the blue Set-up icon under Common components sub-directory.

b. Click on the blue Set-up icon under the TF sub-directory

Running the program
You should set your monitor display at 800 X 600 pixels or higher by clicking on Start | Settings | Control Panel | Display | Settings. To run the program click on its icon or use the Run command and enter C:\TF-2003\TF2003.EXE
If you did not get an icon you create one by dragging the TF2003.EXE item from the explorer listing into a folder.
The first time you run the program it will ask you for an Authorization Key.
The back of the CD case contains a label with your Authorization Key.

Once you activated the program please proceed with the Configuration items described below.

Configuration

Preparer information

Select the Configure|Preparer menu. The Tax Preparer Information window will appear where you enter the following categories of information:

1. Your Firms Information

2. Defaults for new returns

Your Firm's Information

On the Tax Preparer Information window, enter the name and address of your firm.

Defaults for a New Return

The defaults for a new return provide the means to speed up the preparation process.
You enter the following information:

Province: You should select the province of jurisdiction of the majority of your clients by clicking on the down arrow button of the province box. The province you select here will appear automatically as Province of

Residence on each return prepared for the first time. if applicable. The Province of Residence can be overridden on the applicable form if necessary.

City: You should enter the city where the majority of your clients live. The city you enter here will appear automatically on page 1 of each T3 return prepared for the first time. The city (part of the Clients address) can be overridden on page 1 for clients who do not live in the default city specified here.

Data Directories

You have to set up the data directories before you use VisualTax. Select Configure|Data Directories from the menu bar.
This configuration step is very important for the smooth operation of Visual Tax.

The following should be kept in mind:
You must not create VisualTax data directories using DOS, Windows or other programs. All data directories to be used for storing VisualTax data must be created with the Data Directories screen.

Creating a data directory using this VisualTax screen does two things:

- It automatically creates a standard directory, if it does not already exist (as it would have been done via DOS or Windows)

- It initializes the data directory with empty databases, ready for storing data.

In the Data Directories screen enter the following:

Current Directory

This directory is the data directory used by all data base operations of the program such as Open and Save. The following are examples of valid data directory names:
C:\TF-2003\Data
C:\Files03
G:\data (G can be a Network drive)
A:\Data

Note 1: In the last case, Visual Tax creates a data directory called ‘data’ on floppy drive A and initializes the floppy to be used for Visual Tax data. You may repeat this process many times using different floppy disks if your data is stored primarily on floppy disks.

Note 2: Once you start operating the program (during a session) you can change the Current directory to any other data directory you created via this Data Directory screen. For example, you can change the Current Data Directory in the Open screen.

Default Directory

This data directory is the one used by Visual Tax during the Logon process. The rules are identical to the ones described above for the current directory. This directory should be the one most frequently used.

Last Year's Directory

Enter the data directory name that you used in the previous tax year.
Example: C:\TF-2002\Data
Visual Tax will use this directory on the Import screen as Previous Years data directory when it is initially displayed.
If there is no previous years data directory, you should use the current years data directory.

Print Templates

This configuration option allows you to build your custom templates for printing. For example, you can specify what forms and how many copies of each form should be printed for Revenue Canada.

The Print Templates screen is accessible as follows:
Select Configure | Print Templates from the menu bar.
VisualTax provides six (6) templates to be used for different purposes.
The first three are named Revenue Canada, Client and Preparer.

The remaining three templates are not designated for anything specific.

Note 1: Keep in mind that any template can be used for any purpose, therefore its name is not significant in any way. It is up to you to decide how it is going to be used.

Note 2: The order of forms in the Forms to Print list box is not the order in which forms will be printed. The order is predefined at disk distribution time, but it may be changed by using Utilities | Advanced | Change Forms Specifications and locating Print Sequence heading.

Note 3: The Forms to Print in each template, does not mean that the forms will always be printed. It simply means that these forms will be considered for printing but they will print only if they are applicable (have data) for the return currently being printed.

Note 4: The Forms Available list box contains all pages of all forms offered by Visual Tax. Ensure that when you select a form, you include all pages, and not only its first page. Pages are named as xxxx_1, xxxx_2, etc.

Note 5: There is no Cancel operation on this screen. Whatever changes you make on this screen are going to be saved.

The following steps should be carried out in the order they are listed:

- Select the print template you want to set up by clicking the appropriate radio button. For example, click Rev Canada to set up the print template for forms that you want VisualTax to print for Revenue Canada purpose. Notice that the right list box will have a heading according to the selection you make. For example, if you select the Rev Canada radio button, the right hand list box will have the following marking on top, "Forms to print for Rev Canada."

- On the left list box marked Forms Available, select the form you want to include in the print set. You can do that by either double clicking the form you want to include, or selecting a form then pressing the Add button. This method is fine when only a few forms are to be included in the Forms to Print list box. If you are planning to add a long list to the Forms to Print, it may be faster to do the following:

- Empty the Forms to Print list box by clicking on the Remove All icon.
- Click the Add All icon to add all available forms to the Forms to Print list box.
- Remove the forms you do not want by double clicking on the copies column of the Forms to Print list box.

Once a form is added to the right list box, you can set the number of copies to print for that form (1 to 9).

The default is 1.

- Continue step 2 until you have included all the forms you want to print in the set.

- Click Exit when you have finished. All modified templates are automatically saved on your hard disk program directory.

Converting from the previous year

Click on File | Import from last year.
During Save change the File Name and Data directory to reflect the New Year end and the new data directory.

In both cases the program will do the following:

T3 returns:
The program will carry forward the basic trust identification data and any beneficiary identification data. All dollar amounts will be zeroed out.

Partnership returns:
All data including the dollar amounts, distribution to partners, etc. will be carried forward as they were last year. You should review the data and revise as necessary. Ensure that the fiscal period is revised to reflect the new year.

Charity returns:
All data including the dollar amounts will be carried forward as they were last year. You should review the data and revise as necessary. Ensure that the fiscal period is revised to reflect the New Year.

Other stand alone forms:
All data including the dollar amounts will be carried forward as they were last year. You should review the data and revise as necessary. Ensure that the fiscal period is revised to reflect the New Year.

Note: If you do not want last year's data to come into the new return you should open a new return.

Your first T3 return

A. Calculate the Net Income of the Trust
Open a new return by clicking on the New icon.

Click on Forms and then Double click on Jacket (T3) item under Trust Return.
Press Enter to activate the data entry mode.

Enter the Trust identification data on this form. (Name, Account, Year End, etc.).

Enter the Trust Income:
Click on the Forms icon and then double click on S08-Canadian Investments (W/S).

Enter some income on this worksheet (if applicable) under the Income column and press Enter.

Similarly, enter other income on other forms as required.
The Net income of the trust will show immediately on the Tax Status bar at the bottom of the main form.

B. Allocate the income to beneficiaries (optional)

Enter expenses (if any) against income available for allocation
Double click on the Allocation Worksheet (in the Forms Index) and enter any expenses against income.

Enter beneficiaries:
Double click on the 'beneficiary data' item of the Forms index.
Enter the Recipient-Id of the beneficiary, Name, Address and the allocation option. If there are more beneficiaries press PgDn or click the next statement icon and continue the same way.

Enter other data as described below:
TYPE OF BENEFICIARY

Canadian Resident: Enter Y or N
Preferred Beneficiary: Enter Y or N

ALLOCATION OPTION
The program defaults to even allocation and it is fully automatic.

Even Allocation: If income is allocated evenly among all beneficiaries enter Y. The program will automatically allocate the proper percentage based on the number of beneficiaries. If there is only one beneficiary, he(she) will be allocated 100% of the income.
Specific % allocation: You have the option of allocating different percentages to any of the beneficiaries. For example in the case of two beneficiaries you could allocate 60% and 40% respectively.

Manual Allocation: You can enter Y on this box if you need full control of how the income is going to be allocated. Once you select this option, the program allows you to enter your own amounts on the various income boxes of the slip.

In all cases Schedule 9 is automatically calculated based on the allocation parameters of the beneficiary slips.

The return is completed now.
To Save the data press F3 or Click on the Save button.

To print the return and/or the supplementary slips click on the Print item of the top menu.

For further orientation to the program click any of the icons. It will give you a feeling of the program.

Your first Partnership (T5013) return

A. Calculate the Income of the Partnership
Open a new return (click on the New icon)
Click on Forms and then Double click on T5013-Partnership Return
Complete the Identification data and Income data (page 1 and 2).
Page 1 of the jacket comes up.
Press Enter to activate the data entry mode.

Enter the Partnership identification data on page 1 and income data on page 2.

B. Enter Partners data on form T5015
Click on Forms and then Double click on T5015-Reconciliation of Partners Capital Account.

Enter the following:
Allocation method:
Click on the appropriate allocation method:
a. Allocation based on Capital Account Balance of each partner.
or
b. Allocation based on Units held by each partner

The program will calculate the percentage for each partner based on the total balance or total units.

Now enter identification for each partner (name, address, etc.) and capital account amounts.
If there are more partners that can fit in the first page, you can click on the next statement icon and continue the same way.

The calculated percentage can be overridden, if you enter Y on the field Override Allocation at the top right hand of the form.

Based on the above the program will prepare automatically the T5013 slips for each partner.

The return is completed now.
To Save the data press F3 or Click on the Save button.
To print the return and/or the supplementary slips click on the Print icon.

For further orientation to the program click any of the icons.

It will give you a feeling of the program.

Other returns and stand-alone forms

Click on the Forms and double click on the form you want to prepare.
To Save the data press F3 or Click on the Save button.
To print the form click on Print | Current Form.